



RS 540 (AFCO 8520)

Safety Data Sheet

according to Federal Register / Vol. 77, No. 58 / Monday, March 26, 2012 / Rules and Regulations
Revision Date: 01/07/2025

Version: 1.3

SECTION 1: IDENTIFICATION

Product Identifier

Product Form: Mixture

Product Name: RS 540

Product Code: AFCO 8520

Intended Use of the Product

Use of the Substance/Mixture: Caustic cleaner for use on food processing equipment. For professional use only.

Name, Address, and Telephone of the Responsible Party

Company

AFCO

550 Development Avenue

Chambersburg, PA 17201

T: 800-345-1329

www.afcocare.com

Emergency Telephone Number

Emergency Number : 1-800-424-9300 (CHEMTREC)

SECTION 2: HAZARDS IDENTIFICATION

Classification of the Substance or Mixture

Classification (GHS-US)

Met. Corr. 1 H290

Skin Corr. 1A H314

Eye Dam. 1 H318

Aquatic Acute 3 H402

Label Elements

GHS-US Labeling

Hazard Pictograms (GHS-US)

:



GHS05

Signal Word (GHS-US)

: Danger.

Hazard Statements (GHS-US)

: H290 - May be corrosive to metals

H314 - Causes severe skin burns and eye damage

H318 - Causes serious eye damage

H402 - Harmful to aquatic life

Precautionary Statements (GHS-US)

: P234 - Keep only in original container.

P260 - Do not breathe vapors, mist, spray.

P264 - Wash hands, forearms, and other exposed areas thoroughly after handling.

P280 - Wear protective glove, protective clothing, eye protection, face protection.

P301+P330+P331 - IF SWALLOWED: rinse mouth. Do NOT induce vomiting.

P303+P361+P353 - IF ON SKIN (or hair): Remove/Take off immediately all contaminated clothing. Rinse skin with water/shower.

P304+P340 - IF INHALED: Remove victim to fresh air and keep at rest in a position comfortable for breathing.

P305+P351+P338 - If in eyes: Rinse cautiously with water for several minutes. Remove contact lenses, if present and easy to do. Continue rinsing.

P310 - Immediately call a POISON CENTER or doctor/physician.

P321 - Specific treatment (see section 4).

P363 - Wash contaminated clothing before reuse.

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P390 - Absorb spillage to prevent material damage.
P405 - Store locked up.
P406 - Store in corrosive resistant container with a resistant inner liner.
P501 - Dispose of contents/container to local, regional, national, territorial, provincial, and international regulations.

Other Hazards

Other Hazards Not Contributing to the Classification: Exposure may aggravate those with pre-existing eye, skin, or respiratory conditions. When heated to decomposition, emits toxic fumes. Contact with metals may evolve flammable hydrogen gas.

Unknown Acute Toxicity (GHS-US): Not available.

SECTION 3: COMPOSITION/INFORMATION ON INGREDIENTS

Substances

Mixture

Name	Product identifier	% (w/w)	Classification (GHS-US)
Water	(CAS No) 7732-18-5	70-80	Not classified.
Sodium hydroxide	(CAS No) 1310-73-2	20 – 30	Met. Corr. 1, H290 Skin Corr. 1A, H314 Eye Dam. 1, H318 Aquatic Acute 3, H402
D-Glucopyranose, oligomeric, decyl octyl glycosides	(CAS No) 68515-73-1	0.1-1	Eye Dam. 1, H318
Sodium glucoheptonate	(CAS No) 31138-65-5	0.1 - 1	Not classified

Full text of H-phrases: see section 16.

SECTION 4: FIRST AID MEASURES

Description of First Aid Measures

General: Never give anything by mouth to an unconscious person. If you feel unwell, seek medical advice (show the label where possible).

Inhalation: When symptoms occur: go into open air and ventilate suspected area. Remove to fresh air and keep at rest in a position comfortable for breathing. Obtain medical attention if breathing difficulty persists.

Skin Contact: Remove contaminated clothing. Drench affected area with water for at least 15 minutes. Obtain medical attention if irritation persists. Wash contaminated clothing before reuse.

Eye Contact: Rinse cautiously with water for several minutes. Remove contact lenses, if present and easy to do. Continue rinsing. Obtain medical attention if irritation develops or persists.

Ingestion: Rinse mouth. Do NOT induce vomiting. Immediately call a POISON CENTER or doctor/physician.

Most Important Symptoms and Effects Both Acute and Delayed

General: Causes serious eye damage. Corrosive to eyes, respiratory system and skin..

Inhalation: None under normal and intended conditions of use.

Skin Contact: Causes severe skin burns and eye damage..

Eye Contact: Causes serious eye damage.

Ingestion: Ingestion is likely to be harmful or have adverse effects. Contact may cause immediate severe irritation progressing quickly to chemical burns.

Chronic Symptoms: Not available.

Indication of Any Immediate Medical Attention and Special Treatment Needed

If exposed or concerned, get medical advice and attention.

SECTION 5: FIRE-FIGHTING MEASURES

Extinguishing Media

Suitable Extinguishing Media: Water spray, fog, carbon dioxide, foam, dry chemical.

Unsuitable Extinguishing Media: Do not use a heavy water stream. Use of heavy stream of water may spread fire.

Special Hazards Arising From the Substance or Mixture

Fire Hazard: Not flammable.

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Explosion Hazard: Product is not explosive.

Reactivity: Thermal decomposition generates: Corrosive vapors. When heated to decomposition, emits toxic fumes. Toxic gas. Corrosive to soft metals.

Advice for Firefighters

Precautionary Measures Fire: Exercise caution when fighting any chemical fire.

Firefighting Instructions: Use water spray or fog for cooling exposed containers.

Protection During Firefighting: Do not enter fire area without proper protective equipment, including respiratory protection.

Hazardous Combustion Products: Carbon oxides (CO, CO₂). Toxic fumes are released. Sodium oxides (Na₂O).

Other information: Do not allow run-off from fire fighting to enter drains or water courses.

Reference to Other Sections

Refer to section 9 for flammability properties.

SECTION 6: ACCIDENTAL RELEASE MEASURES

Personal Precautions, Protective Equipment and Emergency Procedures

General Measures: Do not allow product to spread into the environment. Do NOT breathe (vapors, mist, spray). Do not get in eyes, on skin, or on clothing.

For Non-Emergency Personnel

Protective Equipment: Use appropriate personal protection equipment (PPE).

Emergency Procedures: Evacuate unnecessary personnel.

For Emergency Personnel

Protective Equipment: Equip cleanup crew with proper protection.

Emergency Procedures: Ventilate area.

Environmental Precautions

Prevent entry to sewers and public waters. Avoid release to the environment.

Methods and Material for Containment and Cleaning Up

For Containment: Contain any spills with dikes or absorbents to prevent migration and entry into sewers or streams. Cautiously neutralize spilled liquid.

Methods for Cleaning Up: Clear up spills immediately and dispose of waste safely. Cautiously neutralize spilled liquid. Contact competent authorities a spill.

Reference to Other Sections

See heading 8, Exposure Controls and Personal Protection.

SECTION 7: HANDLING AND STORAGE

Precautions for Safe Handling

Additional Hazards When Processed: When heated to decomposition, emits toxic fumes. Corrosive vapors are released. Contact with soft metals may evolve flammable hydrogen gas.

Hygiene Measures: Handle in accordance with good industrial hygiene and safety procedures. Wash hands and other exposed areas with mild soap and water before eating, drinking, or smoking and again when leaving work. Do not eat, drink or smoke when using this product. Wash hands and forearms thoroughly after handling.

Conditions for Safe Storage, Including Any Incompatibilities

Technical Measures: Comply with applicable regulations.

Storage Conditions: Store in a dry, cool and well-ventilated place. Keep container closed when not in use. Keep/Store away from extremely low temperatures, incompatible materials.

Incompatible Materials: Strong acids. Strong oxidizers. Metals.

Special Rules on Packaging: Keep only in original container.

Specific End Use(s): Caustic foam cleaner for use on food processing equipment. For professional use only.

SECTION 8: EXPOSURE CONTROLS/PERSONAL PROTECTION

Control Parameters

No Occupational Exposure Limits (OELs) have been established for this product or any of its chemical components.

Sodium hydroxide (1310-73-2)		
Mexico	OEL Ceiling (mg/m ³)	2 mg/m ³

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USA ACGIH	ACGIH Ceiling (mg/m ³)	2 mg/m ³
USA OSHA	OSHA PEL (TWA) (mg/m ³)	2 mg/m ³
USA NIOSH	NIOSH REL (ceiling) (mg/m ³)	2 mg/m ³
USA IDLH	US IDLH (mg/m ³)	10 mg/m ³
Ontario	OEL Ceiling (mg/m ³)	5 ppm
Québec	PLAFOND (mg/m ³)	50 ppm

Exposure Controls

Appropriate Engineering Controls: Emergency eye wash fountains and safety showers should be available in the immediate vicinity of any potential exposure. Ensure all national/local regulations are observed. Ensure adequate ventilation, especially in confined areas. Alarm detectors should be used when toxic gases may be released. If user operations generate fumes, vapor, spray, or mist use process enclosures, local exhaust ventilation, or other engineering controls to keep worker exposure to airborne contaminants below any recommended or statutory limits.

Personal Protective Equipment: Protective goggles. Facemask/Faceshield with Protective goggles/glasses. Protective clothing. Gloves.



Materials for Protective Clothing: Chemically resistant materials and fabrics. Corrosion-proof clothing.

Hand Protection: Wear chemically resistant protective gloves.

Eye Protection: Chemical goggles & face shield.

Skin and Body Protection: Wear suitable protective clothing.

Respiratory Protection: None needed under normal and intended conditions of product use.

Other Information: When using, do not eat, drink or smoke.

SECTION 9: PHYSICAL AND CHEMICAL PROPERTIES

Information on Basic Physical and Chemical Properties

Physical State	: Liquid.
Appearance	: Clear, dark brown.
Odor	: Slight.
Odor Threshold	: Not available.
pH	: >13
Relative Evaporation Rate (butylacetate=1)	: Not available.
Melting Point	: Not available.
Freezing Point	: Not available.
Boiling Point	: 105°C (221°F)
Flash Point	: None.
Auto-ignition Temperature	: None.
Decomposition Temperature	: Not available.
Flammability (solid, gas)	: Not available.
Lower Flammable Limit	: Not available.
Upper Flammable Limit	: Not available.
Vapor Pressure	: Not available.
Relative Vapor Density at 20°C	: Not available.
Specific Gravity	: 1.30
Solubility	: Complete.
Partition coefficient: n-octanol/water	: Not available.
Viscosity	: Not available.
Explosion Data – Sensitivity to Mechanical Impact	: Not expected to present an explosion hazard due to mechanical impact.
Explosion Data – Sensitivity to Static Discharge	: Not expected to present an explosion hazard due to static discharge.

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SECTION 10: STABILITY AND REACTIVITY

Reactivity: Thermal decomposition generates: Corrosive vapors. When heated to decomposition, emits toxic fumes. Toxic gas. Corrosive to soft metals.

Chemical Stability: Stable under normal conditions.

Possibility of Hazardous Reactions: Hazardous polymerization will not occur.

Conditions to Avoid: Extremely low temperatures. Prolonged contact with soft metals. Incompatible materials.

Incompatible Materials: Strong acids. Strong oxidizers. Metals.

Hazardous Decomposition Products: Carbon oxides (CO, CO₂). Thermal decomposition generates: Toxic gases. Sodium oxides.

SECTION 11: TOXICOLOGICAL INFORMATION

Information on Toxicological Effects - Product

Acute Toxicity: Not classified.

LD50 and LC50 Data: Not available.

Skin Corrosion/Irritation: Causes severe skin burns. (pH: N/A)

Serious Eye Damage/Irritation: Causes serious eye damage. (pH: N/A)

Respiratory or Skin Sensitization: Not classified.

Germ Cell Mutagenicity: Not classified.

Teratogenicity: Not available.

Carcinogenicity: Not classified.

Specific Target Organ Toxicity (Repeated Exposure): Not classified.

Reproductive Toxicity: Not classified.

Specific Target Organ Toxicity (Single Exposure): Not classified.

Aspiration Hazard: Not classified.

Symptoms/Injuries After Inhalation: None under normal and intended conditions of use.

Symptoms/Injuries After Skin Contact: Causes severe skin burns and eye damage.

Symptoms/Injuries After Eye Contact: Causes serious eye damage.

Symptoms/Injuries After Ingestion: Ingestion is likely to be harmful or have adverse effects. Contact may cause immediate severe irritation progressing quickly to chemical burns.

Information on Toxicological Effects - Ingredient(s)

LD50 and LC50 Data:

Water (7732-18-5)	
LD50 Oral Rat	>90000 mg/kg

SECTION 12: ECOLOGICAL INFORMATION

Toxicity

Ecology - General: Harmful to aquatic life with long lasting effects.

Sodium hydroxide (1310-73-2)	
LC50 Fish 1	40 mg/l

Persistence and Degradability

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Persistence and Degradability	Not established.

Bioaccumulative Potential

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Bioaccumulative Potential	Not established.

Mobility in Soil Not available.

Other Adverse Effects

Other Information: Avoid release to the environment.

SECTION 13: DISPOSAL CONSIDERATIONS

Waste Disposal Recommendations: Dispose of waste material in accordance with all local, regional, national, provincial, territorial and international regulations.

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Ecology - Waste Materials: This material is hazardous to the aquatic environment. Keep out of sewers and waterways.

SECTION 14: TRANSPORT INFORMATION

14.1 In Accordance with DOT

Proper Shipping Name : CORROSIVE LIQUID, BASIC, INORGANIC, N.O.S. (Sodium hydroxide)
Hazard Class : 8
Identification Number : UN3266
Label Codes : 8
Packing Group : III
ERG Number : 154



14.2 In Accordance with IMDG

Proper Shipping Name : CORROSIVE LIQUID, BASIC, INORGANIC, N.O.S. (Sodium hydroxide)
Hazard Class : 8
Identification Number : UN3266
Packing Group : III
Label Codes : 8
EmS-No. (Fire) : F-A
EmS-No. (Spillage) : S-B



14.3 In Accordance with IATA

Proper Shipping Name : CORROSIVE LIQUID, BASIC, INORGANIC, N.O.S. (Sodium hydroxide)
Packing Group : III
Identification Number : UN3266
Hazard Class : 8
Label Codes : 8
ERG Code (IATA) : 8L



14.4 In Accordance with TDG

Proper Shipping Name : CORROSIVE LIQUID, BASIC, INORGANIC, N.O.S. (Sodium hydroxide)
Packing Group : III
Hazard Class : 8
Identification Number : UN3266
Label Codes : 8



SECTION 15: REGULATORY INFORMATION

US Federal Regulations

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SARA Section 311/312 Hazard Classes	Immediate (acute) health hazard.
Water (7732-18-5)	
Listed on the United States TSCA (Toxic Substances Control Act) inventory.	
Sodium hydroxide (1310-73-2)	
Listed on the United States TSCA (Toxic Substances Control Act) inventory.	
D-Glucopyranose, oligomeric, decyl octyl glycosides (68515-73-1)	
Listed on the United States TSCA (Toxic Substances Control Act) inventory.	
Sodium glucoheptonate (31138-65-5)	
Listed on the United States TSCA (Toxic Substances Control Act) inventory.	

US State Regulations

Sodium hydroxide (1310-73-2)
U.S. - California - SCAQMD - Toxic Air Contaminants - Non-Cancer Acute
U.S. - California - Toxic Air Contaminant List (AB 1807, AB 2728)

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U.S. - New Jersey - Discharge Prevention - List of Hazardous Substances
RTK - U.S. - New Jersey - Right to Know Hazardous Substance List
U.S. - New Jersey - Special Health Hazards Substances List
U.S. - New York - Occupational Exposure Limits - TWAs
U.S. - New York - Reporting of Releases Part 597 - List of Hazardous Substances
RTK - U.S. - Pennsylvania - RTK (Right to Know) - Environmental Hazard List
RTK - U.S. - Pennsylvania - RTK (Right to Know) List
U.S. - Texas - Effects Screening Levels - Long Term
U.S. - Texas - Effects Screening Levels - Short Term

D-Glucopyranose, oligomeric, decyl octyl glycosides (68515-73-1)

U.S. - Texas - Effects Screening Levels - Long Term.

U.S. - Texas - Effects Screening Levels - Short Term.

Canadian Regulations

Water (7732-18-5)

Listed on the Canadian DSL (Domestic Substances List) inventory.

Sodium hydroxide (1310-73-2)

Listed on the Canadian DSL (Domestic Substances List) inventory.

D-Glucopyranose, oligomeric, decyl octyl glycosides (68515-73-1)

Listed on the Canadian DSL (Domestic Substances List) inventory.

Sodium glucoheptonate (31138-65-5)

Listed on the Canadian DSL (Domestic Substances List) inventory.

This product has been classified in accordance with the hazard criteria of the Controlled Products Regulations (CPR) and the SDS contains all of the information required by CPR.

SECTION 16: OTHER INFORMATION, INCLUDING DATE OF PREPARATION OR LAST REVISION

Revision date : 01/07/2025

Other Information : This document has been prepared in accordance with the SDS requirements of the OSHA Hazard Communication Standard 29 CFR 1910.1200.

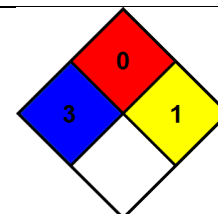
GHS Full Text Phrases:

Aquatic Acute 3	Hazardous to the aquatic environment - Acute Hazard Category 3.
Eye Dam. 1	Serious eye damage/eye irritation Category 1.
Met. Corr. 1	Corrosive to metals Category 1.
Skin Corr. 1A	Skin corrosion/irritation Category 1A.
H290	May be corrosive to metals.
H314	Causes severe skin burns and eye damage.
H318	Causes serious eye damage.
H402	Harmful to aquatic life.

NFPA Health Hazard : 3 - Short exposure could cause serious temporary or residual injury even though prompt medical attention was given.

NFPA Fire Hazard : 0 - Materials that will not burn.

NFPA Reactivity : 1 - Normally stable, but can become unstable at elevated temperatures and pressures or may react with water with some release of energy, but not violently.



HMIS III Rating

Health : 3 Serious Hazard - Major injury likely unless prompt action is taken, and medical treatment is given.

Flammability : 0 - Minimal Hazard.

Physical : 1 - Slight Hazard.

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Party Responsible for the Preparation of This Document

AFCO
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T: 800-345-1329

This information is based on our current knowledge and is intended to describe the product for the purposes of health, safety and environmental requirements only. It should not therefore be construed as guaranteeing any specific property of the product.

North America GHS SDS 2015 (U.S., Can., Mex.)